

THE ATHLEADER PLAYBOOK

Lesson 5

Lead the 90-Day Way

Sustain & Optimize

About 95 minutes of reps this week. Your core rep, Drill 5.2, takes about 30.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 5

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 5

Welcome to the lesson where all your foundational work (your M.V.P. Blueprint, your A.R.A.W. awareness) gets translated into a powerful, executable plan. This is where strategy meets the pavement. You have the 'why' and the 'where'; the 90-Day Way is the 'how.'

The drills in this lesson are the most practical yet. They are designed to move you from reflection to structured action, giving you the clarity and momentum needed to make significant progress in a single "season."

"What separates the 8% who succeed? It's not just about setting goals. It's about having a system to achieve them consistently."

Source: University of Scranton research, as reported in Psychology Today, "92 Percent of People Never Achieve Their Goals" (December 2024).

Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Alignment

Ensuring your goals and actions are in perfect harmony with your M.V.P. Blueprint.

Wellbeing

Building a sustainable plan includes celebration and prevents burnout by focusing on what truly matters.

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Identify the essential prerequisites ("Elements of Success") required to achieve your vision.
- Conduct an honest gap analysis between your current state and your required state.
- Transform your most critical gaps into 2-3 powerful SMART goals.
- Learn how to assess your goals against the A.R.A.W. pillars.
- Build out your first comprehensive 90-Day Way plan using the 90-Day Way Scorecard.

As you build your plan, we want you to amplify its impact by considering your key relationships. Ask yourself throughout this lesson:

- Who will benefit if I achieve this goal?
- Who might need to be brought along with me on this journey?

START HERE

Drill 5.2: Gap Analysis & SMART Goal Creation

Your core rep this week, about 30 minutes.

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Goals aren’t just what you aim for. They’re who you become on the way there.

Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas and “aha” moments from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 5 videos.

Elements of Success (My Prerequisites):

Gap Analysis & SMART Goals:

Building My 90-Day Action Plan:

LESSON 5 · ABOUT 95 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

This is where you start putting in the reps.

Drill 5.1

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

The Elements of Success

Alignment

20 min

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Drill 5.2

CORE REP · START HERE

Gap Analysis & SMART Goal Creation

Alignment

30 min

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Drill 5.3

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Build Your 90-Day Action Plan

Wellbeing · in your Scorecard, Part 3

30 min

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Scorecard

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Part 4, your weekly check-in

All four · every week from now on

15 min

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Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Complete your core rep, then ask one person how it landed.

Drill 5.1 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 20 minutes

The Elements of Success (Your Prerequisite Check)

Before building your plan, you need to know what success requires. Based on the career path and vision you've defined, what are the non-negotiable prerequisites required?

Instructions: For each category below, brainstorm what is required to achieve your vision, from you and from the people around you. Don't assess yourself yet; just list the requirements.

Mindset

e.g., Confidence to lead a larger team, resilience to handle executive-level pressure...

Experience

e.g., P&L management experience, leading a cross-functional team...

Motivation & Energy

e.g., Sustainable drive for a multi-year project...

Knowledge/Skills

e.g., Deep knowledge of market trends, advanced data analysis skills...

Network

e.g., Relationships with senior-level leaders, a strong mentor...

Resources (Time, Financial, etc.)

e.g., 10 hours per week for study, budget for a course...

Worksheet: Current Role & Team Alignment

Review the prerequisites you listed above. How aligned are these goals with the current needs of your role and the objectives of your team? Where is there synergy? Where might there be tension?

Drill 5.2 | Core rep · start here | About 30 minutes

Gap Analysis & SMART Goal Creation

Now, assess yourself against the prerequisites you just listed. Where are you strong, and where are the most critical gaps? These gaps become your goals.

Skipped Drill 5.1? Start by listing what your vision needs from you, then pick the two or three gaps that matter most.

Transform Gaps into SMART Goals:

1. Review your list from Drill 5.1.
2. Identify the top two or three most critical gaps that are holding you back right now.
3. Transform each gap into a powerful SMART goal using the template.

Template →

Within **[Time-bound]**, I will **[Specific Action]** so that I can **[Measurable Outcome]**, which is **[Relevant]** to my vision of **[Your Vision]** and is **[Attainable]** with my current resources.

Example

Gap: *Lack of public speaking experience.*

SMART Goal: *"Within the next 90 days, I will complete a public speaking course and deliver at least two presentations to internal teams, so that I can receive measurable feedback on my performance, which is relevant to my vision of becoming a recognized thought leader and is attainable with my current professional development budget."*

My Top 3 Critical Gaps:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My SMART Goal #1:

My SMART Goal #2:

My SMART Goal #3:

Reflection & Prioritization:

Of the SMART goals you just drafted, which one, if achieved, would best equip you to lead through change? Choose it.

○ Goal #1 ○ Goal #2 ○ Goal #3

Considering the time and energy required, what time are you willing to commit toward this primary goal each week?

Each week: _____

How to Assess Your Core 4 A.R.A.W. Focus

Before you build your action plan, you need to decide which A.R.A.W. pillar each goal primarily conditions. This helps you be intentional about your growth. Use these questions to guide you:

Does this goal build my...

- **Agility?** (My ability to adapt, learn, and respond to change.)
- **Resilience?** (My ability to manage pressure, setbacks, and my energy.)
- **Alignment?** (My ability to connect my actions to my purpose and create clarity for others.)
- **Wellbeing?** (My ability to maintain health, focus, and sustainability.)

Drill 5.3 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 30 minutes

Build Your 90-Day Action Plan

This is the final step: building your plan in your 90-Day Way Scorecard.

Instructions:

- ☐ Open your 90-Day Way Scorecard.
- ☐ Transfer your two or three SMART goals into **Part 3: Game Plan**.
- ☐ For EACH goal, complete the remaining columns by brainstorming the specific actions and details needed.

Action Plan Checklist (for each goal):

For each goal in Part 3	Goal #1	Goal #2	Goal #3
Core 4 Pillar Focus: Using the guide above, which A.R.A.W. muscle does this goal primarily condition?	☐	☐	☐
Daily/Weekly Actions: (e.g., Not "network more," but "Reach out to 2 people on LinkedIn per week.")	☐	☐	☐
Resources Needed: (e.g., Time block in calendar, intro from my Player-Coach...)	☐	☐	☐
Deadline: The specific date this SMART goal will be achieved.	☐	☐	☐
Accountability: Who will you share this goal with? Name them.	☐	☐	☐
Celebration: How will you reward yourself for achieving this goal?	☐	☐	☐

Scorecard Part 4: Your Weekly Check-In

Fifteen minutes, every week from now on: open Part 4 of your Scorecard, check each goal, and note what you'll adjust.

My check-in day: _____ Time: _____

- ☐ I've done my first weekly check-in.

Locker Room Reflection

After building your 90-day plan, what is the biggest feeling you have (e.g., clarity, excitement, nervousness)? What does that feeling tell you about your readiness to execute?

Quick Self-Check

Just for you. Your Pulse Check, the one that tracks your season, is in the course.

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
My 90-day plan feels directly connected to my M.V.P. Blueprint.	○	○	○	○	○
I have a clear understanding of how my 90-day goals will condition my Agility, Resilience, Alignment, and Wellbeing.	○	○	○	○	○

Get Feedback

Complete your core rep, then ask one person how it landed: your Player-Coach, a peer, someone on your team.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Ryall Graber, then your Pulse Check.